

Round 3 — “The Investigation”

11:00 PM – Midnight

Scene: Hard evidence. Investigation by conversation. Press the alibis. Look at the body. Open bags. Two visual climaxes anchor the round (the five browns, then Val cleared / Marco’s eyewitness moment) — these are run by characters in the room, not by the host.

- **Hold composure** through the first half of the round. Calm. Steady. Even when Val looks guilty. Even when Marco looks guilty.
- **Share in conversation:** Almost nothing. Brief polite answers. Smile.
- When Zoya names Marco as your son: silence.
- When Diego speaks: composure cracks for one beat. Then rebuilds.
- When Gerald cracks: look at him. He flinches.
- When Marco speaks (the eyewitness moment that ends the round): look at him. **Save the confession for Round 4.**

Your moment — the tote search (the visual climax of the round)

This beat is driven by Sunny, the federal agent — not the host. After Irina has broken, Pepe has surfaced the coffee tin, the cotton ball, and the needle cap, and the room is ready to look at the body, Sunny crosses to you with the badge in hand.

- **Sunny:** “Mrs. Reyes. Your bag.”
- **You:** “You can’t be serious.”
- **Sunny:** “Empty it.”
- **You:** Place items on the table, **one at a time. In silence. Slowly.**
 1. The printed Diego photo.
 2. The handkerchief — red Kool-Aid drop + brown smear visible.
 3. The brown Sharpie wrapped in masking tape labeled “INSULIN.”
- Sunny will pick up the Sharpie, peel back the tape, and say:
“Mrs. Reyes, you are not diabetic. And this is a Sharpie.” He will then hold the Sharpie next to the collar, the handkerchief, your stained cuff, and the powder in Irina’s coffee tin — **five matching browns in a line.** He will call Dex for the thermos. Dex will pour real coffee. Sunny will deliver the contrast line.
- **You say nothing.** Through all of it. The silence is the performance.

Save the confession for Round 4.